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Cognitive Science Minor


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Affiliation: Interdisciplinary Studies

Cognitive science is the interdisciplinary study of the mind and its processes — how and why we think the way we think. Perhaps one of the most interdisciplinary fields offered at Truman, cognitive science lies at the crossroads of neuroscience, philosophy, linguistics, psychology, anthropology and artificial intelligence.

GRADUATION REQUIREMENTS:

1. A 2.00 GPA in minor requirements.
2. At least nine hours of the program requirements must be completed at Truman State University.
3. No more than two courses counted for the minor may double-count for the student's major.
4. No more than two courses counted for the minor can come from the same discipline.
5. Courses cannot be double counted to fulfill more than one area of focus. The same course listed as an option under multiple areas of focus can count for only one of those categories.
6. Students who double major may double-count up to two courses from each major.

PROGRAM REQUIREMENTS (16 credits):

The only required course in the minor is IDSM 431 (1 credit), taken after the student has completed the bulk of the other courses in the minor. Students choose from the Area of Focus below for a total of 16 credits, with courses in different areas of focus distributed as **2-2-1** or **2-1-1-1**.

CAPSTONE (1 credit):

- **IDSM 431 - Cognitive Science Readings** Credit(s): 1
After having completed at **least nine (9) credits**, and preferably twelve (12) credits, in the minor, students create and submit a reflective essay geared toward the following:
 1. synthesizing the threads of cognitive science in their program of study to date, and
 2. demonstrating the contribution of their specific coursework and research (and internship experience, if any) to their understanding of the field of cognitive science.

AREAS OF FOCUS (15 credits):

Area I: Computational Cognition

- **CS 291 - Models of Computation** Credit(s): 3
- **CS 345 - Cyberethics** Credit(s): 3
- **CS 480 - Artificial Intelligence** Credit(s): 3
- **CS 484 - Topics in Computer Science** Credit(s): 1 to 3
- **DATA 344 - Data Ethics** Credit(s): 3

Area II: Language and Cognition

- **ENG 211 - WE/Perspectives on Literature and Film** Credit(s): 3
- **ENG 415 - Literature for Children** Credit(s): 4
- **JINS 329 - Language and Meaning** Credit(s): 3
- **JINS 345 - From Page to Stage and Screen (template course)** Credit(s): 3
- **LING 238 - Introduction to Linguistics** Credit(s): 3
- **LING 414 - Language and the Mind** Credit(s): 4

Area III: Philosophy of Cognition

- **PHRE 342 - Symbolic Logic** Credit(s): 3
- **PHRE 370 - Epistemology** Credit(s): 3
- **PHRE 386 - Studies in Philosophy and Religion** Credit(s): 3 to 99 (approved topics only)
- **JINS 3001 - An Interdisciplinary Exploration of Human Consciousness** Credit(s): 3

Area IV: Psychology of Cognition

- **PSYC 332 - Child Development** Credit(s): 3
- **PSYC 370 - Human Sensation and Perception** Credit(s): 3
- **PSYC 373 - Learning and Memory** Credit(s): 3
- **PSYC 377 - Developmental Psychology** Credit(s): 3
- **JINS 3001 - An Interdisciplinary Exploration of Human Consciousness** Credit(s): 3

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